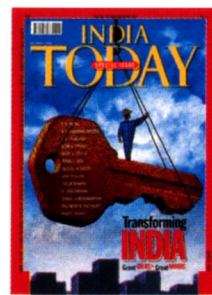


RAVI S SAHANI



"Transforming India",
October 6, 2008

"If the ideas of distinguished persons from different walks of life are implemented pragmatically, they may become paradigms for our future generations."

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Changing India

The biggest problem that India is facing today is the widening gap between the haves and the have-nots ("Transforming India," October 6, 2008), and the ideas of eminent personalities—industrialists, scientists, management gurus and academicians—provide a workable plan and an executable blueprint to bridge this chasm. It holds the key to create the much needed change for our nation's improvement.
K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
on e-mail

Jagdish N. Sheth is right when he says that it is the ideal time for India to make advances in all major areas of development when the whole world seems willing to co-operate and look forward to India's leadership in many fields. We need to focus on eradicating terrorism and corruption, becoming pro-

fessional and disciplined in our approach and promoting team effort and emulating China's success model.
VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
on e-mail

Infosys founder N.R. Narayana Murthy is absolutely right in his assertion that reservations for the candidates belonging to the underprivileged section is a retrograde step. Empowerment should come through proper education from the lowest level onwards. Here is where our state has failed. No purpose is served in reserving seats for these candidates at higher levels. Without a proper foundation at the primary level, benefits like reserving seats in institutes will do them no good. Our politicians prefer to invest in freebies like colour TVs etc. to woo the voters, but not in providing effective primary education, primary

health care and other basic amenities. If they do so, it will help empower those marginalised in a more effective manner.
V. VASUDEVAN, *on e-mail*

The successful experiment by Infosys founder is indeed an eye-opener for those clamouring for reservations for the scs/sts. Investing time, energy and money to equip the marginalised lot at the grassroots level instead is a much better and a viable alternative for others to follow.
R.K. SINGH, *Mumbai*

Kudos to your editorial team for such a wonderful issue. Great minds from varied fields have rightfully mentioned the means to transform India, but it all depends on we, the people, to act on their suggestions to make India a better place to live. Together, we will be able to do it.
D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Terror Turmoil

How do the terrorist outfits like SIMI and IM manage to rope in Muslim youths in their jihad ("The New Terror", September 29)? They can do so because the Muslim community lacks wise leadership and role model for the youth to follow and emulate. The religion is steeped in the conservative and age-old practice, which does not allow any spiritual innovation or growth. There is need for better educational avenues for the community to come out of the morass of poverty, illiteracy and squalor. The alienation will continue further if the community does not wake up and act.
K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN,
Bangalore

Islam is a great religion, a symbol of tolerance, brotherhood, peace and love for humanity. It should not be used as a platform by such